ROBERT REASER

CONTACT INFORMATION

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FIELDS OF INTEREST

Energy Economics, Environmental Economics, Industrial Organization, Applied Micro

CURRENT POSITION

California Independent System Operator
Market Economist *August 2026–Present*
Market Strategy and Governance

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis *2020–Present*
PhD Candidate Economics
Dissertation Committee: David Rapson (chair), James Bushnell, Erich Muehlegger

University of California, Davis *2020–2021*
M.A. Economics

Lewis and Clark College *2016–2019*
B.A. Economics

RESEARCH

Working Papers

"Processing Power: The Effect of Data Centers on Wholesale Electricity Markets" (JMP) (with Owen Kay and Reid Taylor)
Data centers are reversing two decades of flat U.S. electricity demand. Using an hourly, unit-level dispatch model of 23 regional markets linked by constrained transmission, we estimate that data centers raised average wholesale prices 6.8 percent nationally and 16.5 percent in Northern Virginia in 2024–2025. Under our preferred scenario, the national effect reaches 13.5 percent by 2028. Trade raises prices even in regions hosting few data centers. Roughly half the increase in generator payments is a transfer from consumers to inframarginal generation. We also estimate effects on carbon emissions and derive conditions under which load growth lowers retail rates.

Works in Progress

"Incremental Emissions and Interstate Incidence of Data Center Load" (with Owen Kay and Reid Taylor)
"Recovering Unobserved Grid Topology from Electricity Prices"
"Bess Response? Understanding Strategic Battery Bidding in the Texas Electricity Market" (with Reid Taylor)
"The Short-Run Impacts of Grid-Scale Storage Entry in the Texas Electricity Market" (with Reid Taylor)

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

NBER Environment and Energy Economics Program Meeting *Spring 2026*

Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting *Summer 2026*

Western Economic Association International Annual Meeting *Summer 2026*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher
PI: James Bushnell *2024–2025*

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Western Power Trading Forum Graduate Student Fellowship *2025/2026*

UC Davis Economics Department Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award *2021*

TEACHING

Assistantships

Intermediate Microeconomics I	*Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Spring 2021, Winter 2021*
Economics of Risk and Uncertainty	*Winter 2024, Winter 2023*
Intermediate Microeconomics II	*Spring 2025, Fall 2022, Spring 2022, Fall 2021, Fall 2020*
Economies of East Asia	*Winter 2022*
Introductory Microeconomics	*Fall 2025*
Econometrics	*Winter 2025*

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Energy and Environmental Economics Dissertation Group Organizer *2024–2026*

UC Davis Economics Department Theory/Behavioral Student Talk Organizer *2022–2023*

SOFTWARE AND PROGRAMMING

R, Stata, Julia, MATLAB, LaTeX